

Dear Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam,

My name is Varvara Lazarenko, and I would like to express my strong interest in applying for a position in of Research Technician: Alzheimer Biochemical Assay- and Drug Development. With my extensive background in biology and a solid foundation in wet lab techniques, I am highly motivated to contribute to your innovative research on brain cholesterol-targeting interventions for Alzheimer's disease (AD).

My academic background equips me with a solid foundation for this role. Throughout my Bachelor's in Biology, I gained extensive hands-on experience with a range of wet lab methodologies, including PCR, gel electrophoresis, ELISA, western blotting, intracellular recordings, and others. Having also performed behavioural testing in animal models as part of some study projects, I got to understand physiological processes from both molecular and functional perspectives. During my Master's in Medical Biology, I further continued to develop my lab skills through my internship at the Donders Institute, where I participated in *in vivo* calcium imaging and computational data analysis of neuronal networks in mice. These laboratory skills form the backbone of my practical competence in biomedical research.

My professional experience will also be an asset for this technician position. As a Junior Research Assistant at Faculty of Biology, I employed techniques like wire myography and qPCR in studies focused on arterial tone regulation. My involvement in both academic research and clinical trial development at a Contract Research Organization deepened my understanding of translational research and the pipeline from discovery to application. This experience, combined with my internship on the added value at the HAN University of Applied Sciences, has strengthened my capacity for problem solving, communication, and working within interdisciplinary and translational teams.

What excites me most about this opportunity is the chance to contribute to a translational research project with tangible therapeutic potential. I have always been passionate about bridging science and society and improving the population health, which is why I am thrilled about this opportunity to participate in the drug development program aimed at normalizing the enzyme contributing to the lipid dysregulation of AD. I am confident that my lab expertise, analytical thinking, and collaborative mindset would be a valuable asset to the team.

To sum up, I believe that my motivation for drug development pipeline, combined with my comprehensive education and diverse professional experiences, makes me a strong candidate for this Research Technician position.

Thank you for considering my application and, in case any questions arise, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Kind regards,
Varvara Lazarenko